

Central Library — Guidelines & Rules

Borrowing limits, late return fines, and reading room timings — All Registered Members

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Applicable To	All students, research scholars and faculty registered with the Central Library
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1. Membership & Access

1.1 Every registered student is automatically enrolled as a Library member using their University ID card, which doubles as the library card; a separate library card is not issued.

1.2 Entry to the Library requires the ID card to be tapped at the turnstile; bags, food, and beverages are not permitted beyond the entrance lockers, except transparent water bottles.

2. Borrowing Limits & Loan Period

Member Category	Books Allowed	Loan Period
UG Students	4 books	14 days
PG Students	6 books	14 days
Research Scholars (PhD/MPhil)	8 books	30 days
Faculty Members	10 books	One semester
Reference / Reserved-section titles	Not for home loan	Reading room use only

2.1 An **Undergraduate student may borrow up to 4 books at a time for a loan period of 14 days**, renewable once for a further 14 days provided no other member has placed a hold/reservation on the title.

2.2 Renewal may be done in person at the Circulation Desk or online through the Library Portal (OPAC) up to 2 days before the due date; books already overdue are not eligible for online renewal and must be returned/renewed physically after fine clearance.

2.3 Textbooks placed in the "High Demand / Semester Reserve" shelf carry a shorter loan period of 3 days (overnight issue after 5:00 PM, return by 10:00 AM next day) to ensure equitable access during examinations.

3. Late Return Fines

Item Category	Fine Rate
General circulation books	■2 per day, per book
High Demand / Semester Reserve titles	■10 per day, per book
Overnight-issue reserve items	■20 per hour of delay
Lost or irreparably damaged book	Replacement cost + ■200 processing fee

Item Category	Fine Rate
Maximum cumulative fine before card suspension	■500

3.1 Fines accrue automatically from the day following the due date, including Sundays and holidays, and are payable at the Circulation Desk or through the Library Portal.

3.2 A member whose outstanding fine reaches ■500 has borrowing privileges suspended until the fine is cleared; No-Dues Certificates at the end of a semester/programme are withheld until all books are returned and fines settled.

4. Reading Room Timings

Period	Timing
Regular semester (Mon–Sat)	8:00 AM – 10:00 PM
Sundays & Gazetted holidays	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM
Examination period (extended hours)	7:00 AM – 12:00 Midnight, all days
Circulation (borrow/return) counter	9:00 AM – 7:00 PM, Mon–Sat
Vacation / semester break	10:00 AM – 5:00 PM, Mon–Fri only

4.1 During the extended examination-period hours, the Reading Room remains staffed by a duty librarian and security personnel; students must carry their ID card at all times inside the premises.

4.2 Silence zones are strictly enforced in the Reading Room and Reference section; group discussion is permitted only in the designated Discussion Rooms, bookable in advance through the Library Portal.

5. General Conduct in the Library

- Marking, highlighting, or removing pages from Library material is treated as damage and billed at replacement cost.
- Mobile phones must be kept on silent mode; calls must be taken outside the Reading Room.
- Personal books/bags left unattended on reading tables beyond 30 minutes may be moved to the custody desk to free up seating during peak hours.
- Inter-library loan (ILL) requests for titles not held in the Central Library collection may be raised through the Librarian and are subject to the lending institution's terms.

This document summarises Library rules for general member guidance and complements the digital Library Catalogue (OPAC). For the complete Library Manual, contact the Circulation Desk. Queries: library@chitkara.edu.in